

Stephen A. Wenzel

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Education

Meredith College

Master of Arts in Biomedical Sciences, *August 2026- May 2027 (Expected)*

The University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill

B.S. in Biology, Minor in Chemistry and Neuroscience, *August 2018 - May 2022*

Dean's List in Spring 2022

Clinical Experience

Certified Ophthalmic Assistant

Duke Eye Center - Retina & Glaucoma | Durham, NC

September 2024 - November 2025

- Earned the **Certified Ophthalmic Assistant (COA)** credential, qualifying for advanced responsibilities including surgical measurements, patient preparation for the inherited retinal disease clinic, and training of new employees
- Completed comprehensive ophthalmic evaluations supporting up to 9 physicians daily, including OCT imaging, anterior segment exams, refractions, and visual field testing
- Administered dilating agents, intraocular pressure-lowering medications, and topical anesthetics under physician supervision
- Upheld Joint Commission standards and supported quality assurance initiatives to maintain patient safety compliance

Medical Assistant

Western Carolina Ear, Nose, and Throat Specialists, PLLC | Clyde, NC

August 2023 - June 2024

- Managed patient triage and collected detailed medical histories for 20 to 25 patients daily during outpatient clinic visits
- Assisted physicians and physician assistants with clinical exams, in-office procedures, specimen collection, and minor surgeries
- Scribed patient encounters and maintained electronic medical records for accuracy
- Ensured OSHA compliance through instrument sterilization and autoclave operations to maintain infection control standards

Ophthalmic Assistant

Mountain Eye Associates | Clyde, NC

May 2022 - April 2023

- Conducted diagnostic testing, including OCT imaging, refraction, and visual field analysis, for 14 to 16 patients daily
- Prepared patients for cataract surgeries and in-office laser procedures
- Administered ophthalmic medications following strict physician protocols

Selected Shadowing Experience | 235 hours

Otolaryngology: Jacob Jennings, PA-C | 176 hours

Western Carolina Ear, Nose, and Throat Specialists, PLLC | Clyde, NC

Ophthalmology: Dr. Pratap Challa, MD; Dr. Stuart McKinnon, MD, PhD | 21 hours

Duke Department of Ophthalmology | Retina & Glaucoma | Durham, NC

Dermatology: Phaedra Hockman, PA-C; Hannah Seville, PA-C | 24 hours

Mountain Laurel Dermatology | Clyde, NC

Family Medicine: Emily Watson, PA-C; Dr. Thomas Ward, MD | 8 hours

Waynesville Family Practice | Waynesville, NC

Ophthalmology: Dr. David Markoff, MD, FACS; Dr. Caroline Denwood, MD | 6 hours

Mountain Eye Associates | Clyde, NC

Research Experience

Undergraduate Research Assistant

The University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill - Rogers Laboratory | Chapel Hill, NC

August 2021 - May 2022

- Studied how cytoskeletal drug treatments affect microtubule acetylation and mitochondrial transport in *Drosophila melanogaster*
- Reviewed scientific literature to inform experimental design and data interpretation
- Performed fluorescence microscopy and generated kymographs to analyze mitochondrial movement
- Presented research findings via poster at the University of North Carolina Undergraduate Research Expo

Undergraduate Research Assistant

UNC Adams School of Dentistry | Chapel Hill, NC

June 2020 - December 2020

- Conducted systematic literature reviews across biomedical and educational databases to support research on competency-based medical education and healthcare professional assessment
- Screened, organized, and synthesized peer-reviewed literature using standardized inclusion criteria and Microsoft Excel, improving the efficiency and consistency of qualitative research analysis
- Collaborated with faculty researchers to examine definitions of professional competence and Entrustable Professional Activities (EPAs), contributing to the development of a shared framework for health professions education and admissions

Teaching & Leadership

Duke MINDs Learn Committee | *June 2025 - November 2025*

- Organized professional development programs and networking events for early-career Duke employees
- Contributed to cross-departmental planning of recurring events supporting career growth and connection among hospital staff

Marching Band Assistant | *Fall Semesters of 2023 and 2024*

- Guided section leaders and drum majors on leadership skills and season-long planning
- Collaborated with instructors and volunteers to strengthen student musical performance and team engagement

Assistant Scoutmaster | *November 2022 - November 2023*

- Mentored more than 20 Scouts working toward rank advancement and guided several candidates through the Eagle Scout process
- Coordinated monthly with district leaders to help build the troop and organize community service projects

Organic Chemistry II Peer Mentor | *August 2021 - May 2022*

- Led weekly peer mentoring sessions on reaction mechanisms, problem-solving, and core chemistry concepts for groups of 20+ students
- Partnered with UNC Chapel Hill faculty and fellow mentors to help students in a 200-person course stay engaged and improve academic performance

Volunteer Experience

Patient Experience Volunteer | *November 2024 - November 2025*

Duke University Hospital | Durham, NC

- **Recipient, 2025 Most Supportive Volunteer Award**, Duke University Hospital System
- Supported two nursing teams in enhancing care and comfort for more than 30 patients across several medical-surgical units
- Welcomed patients and visitors while organizing clinical equipment and hospital unit resources

Undergraduate COVID-19 Test Site Volunteer | *August 2021 - April 2022*

Carolina COVID-19 Student Services Corps (CSSC) | Chapel Hill, NC

- Directed more than 30 students and staff weekly through onsite COVID-19 testing procedures
- Collected laboratory specimens and coordinated directly with pathology personnel
- Explained testing protocols and public health recommendations to community members

Certifications & Honors

Certified Ophthalmic Assistant (COA) | JCAHPO | *active June 2025 - June 2028*

Basic Life Support (BLS/CPR & AED) | American Heart Association | *active September 2024 - September 2026*

Recipient, Eagle Scout Award | Boy Scouts of America | October 2017